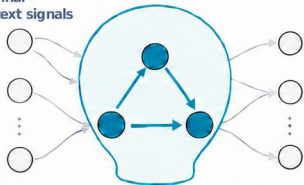


a Normal model computation

The mechanism in its normal context.

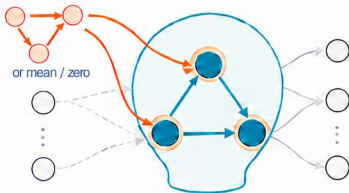
Original
context signals



Circuit structure
Intact context

Evaluate by
intervention

Donor activations



Circuit structure

Context distortion

Retained components recompute from altered inputs.

Circuit fixed; surrounding signals replaced

b Intervention-defined context

Same circuit, but surrounding signals replaced.

c Evaluation can favor a worse circuit

The same candidates can be ranked differently.

Held-out model
agreement

Fixed resampling test



A

B



$Q(A) > Q(B)$

Intervention
faithfulness



B

A



$F(B) > F(A)$

Same frozen, equal-size candidates

Schematic misranking

Recovering intact-model computation $\neq$ scoring well under altered context.